

Ashley Ge Zhang

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(updated Oct 2026)

Education

- 09/2021 – 07/2027 **University of Michigan**
(expected) Ph.D. in Information Science
Ann Arbor, MI Advisors: Steve Oney
Committee: Yan Chen (Virginia Tech), Eytan Adar, Barbara Ericson, and Perry Samson
- 09/2016 – 07/2021 **Peking University**
Beijing, China B.S. in Intelligence Science

Professional Experience

- 09/2021 – present **School of Information, University of Michigan**
Ann Arbor, MI Graduate student and researcher
- 05/2024 – 08/2024 **Adobe, Research Scientist Intern**
San Jose, CA Mentored by Dr. Jane Hoffswell
Developed and evaluated “ConvoMap”, a visualization tool for debugging. (C.8)
- 09/2020 – 05/2021 **Peking University**
Beijing, China Undergraduate student and researcher
Thesis advised by Prof. Tao Xie
- 07/2020 – 02/2021 **University of Washington, Remote Visiting Student**
Seattle, WA Advised by Prof. Amy Zhang
Conducted study on a computational notebook interface for collaboration in data science.
- 09/2019 – 12/2019 **University of Washington, Visiting Student**
Seattle, WA Advised by Prof. Tim Althoff
Developed a tool to classify code snippets as different stages of data science pipelines. (J.2)
- 12/2018 – 05/2019 **Shannon AI, Intern**
Beijing, China Mentored by Dr. Jiwei Li

Publications

Labels:

-  best paper award
-  honorable mention for best paper award

Approximate acceptance rates:

UIST: 20%, CHI: 25%, VL/HCC: 30%, L@S: 23%, KDD: 15%

Heavily-reviewed Conference Papers (C) and Journal Manuscripts (J)

- C.10 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan-Ru Jhou, Yinuo Yang, Shamita Rao, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen, (PDF) Steve Oney (2026) Editrail: Understanding AI Usage by Visualizing Student-AI Interaction in Code. *ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)*, Detroit, MI, USA.
- C.9 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan-Ru Jhou, Yinuo Yang, Shamita Rao, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen, (PDF) Steve Oney (2026) CodeStream: Augmenting Timelines with Code Annotation for Navigating Large Coding Histories. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Barcelona, Spain.
- C.8 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Victor Soares Burszty, Gromit Chan, Shunan Guo, Eunye Koh, (PDF) Steve Oney, Jane Hoffswell (2025) ConvoMap: Interactive Visualizations for Exploring Complex Conversations in Multi-Agent Systems. *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)*, Raleigh, NC, USA.
-  C.7 Yinuo Yang, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Steve Oney, April Yi Wang (2025) SPARK: Real-Time Monitoring of Multi-Faceted Programming Exercises. *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)*, Raleigh, NC, USA.
-  C.6 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Xiaohang Tang, Steve Oney, Yan Chen (2024) CFlow: Supporting Semantic Flow Analysis of Students' Code in Programming Problems at Scale. *ACM Conference on Learning at Scale (L@S)*, Atlanta, GA, USA.
- C.5 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2023) RunEx: Augmenting Regular-Expression Code Search with Runtime Values. *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)*, Washington, D.C., USA.
-  C.4 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2023) VizProg: Identifying Misunderstandings by Visualizing Students' Coding Progress. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Hamburg, Germany.
-  C.3 April Yi Wang, Andrew Head, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Steve Oney, Christopher Brooks (PDF) (2023) Colaroid: A Literate Programming Approach for Authoring Explorable Multi-Stage Tutorials. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Hamburg, Germany.
- J.2 **Ashley Ge Zhang***, Mike Merrill*, Yang Liu, Jeffrey Heer, Tim Althoff (2022) (PDF) CORAL: Code RepresentAtion Learning with Weakly-Supervised Transformers for Analyzing Data Analysis. *European Physical Journal Data Science (EPJ)*.

C.1 Mike Merrill, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Tim Althoff (2021) Mining Collective Data Science Knowledge from Code on the Web to Suggest Alternative Data Analysis Approaches. *ACM Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD)*, Singapore.

Refereed Posters (P), Workshops (W), and Doctoral Consortiums (D)

P.5 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan-Ru Jhou, Yinuo Yang, Shamita Rao, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen, to appear Steve Oney (2026) Editrail: Understanding AI Usage by Visualizing Student-AI Interaction in Code. *Demo at ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)*, Detroit, MI, USA.

D.4 **Ashley Ge Zhang** (2025) Scaling Code Understanding for Introductory Programming in the AI Era. *Online Doctoral Consortium at ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Yokohama, Japan.

W.3 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yinuo Yang, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2025) Understanding And Guiding Student-AI Interaction In Future Programming Education. *Workshop at ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Yokohama, Japan.

P.2 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Xiaohang Tang, Steve Oney, Yan Chen (2024) Demonstration of CFlow: Supporting Semantic Flow Analysis of Students' Code in Programming Problems at Scale. *Demo at ACM Conference on Learning at Scale (L@S)*, Atlanta, GA.

P.1 Shiyu Xu, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Steve Oney (2023) How Pairing by Code Similarity Influences Discussions in Peer Learning. *Late Breaking Work at ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Hamburg, Germany.

Awards

2026 Rising Stars in Data Science by University of Chicago

2026 Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews, UIST

2026 Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews, CHI

2021 – 2026 University of Michigan School of Information's Travel Grant

2022 – 2026 University of Michigan Rackham Conference Travel Grant

2025 Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, VL/HCC
SPARK: Real-Time Monitoring of Multi-Faceted Programming Exercises (C.7)

2024 Best Paper Award, L@S
CFlow: Supporting Semantic Flow Analysis of Students' Code in Programming Problems at Scale (C.6)

- 2024 **Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews, CHI**
- 2023 **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, CHI**
 VizProg: Identifying Misunderstandings by Visualizing Students' Coding Progress (C.4)
- 2023 **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, CHI**
 Colaroid: A Literate Programming Approach for Authoring Explorable Multi-Stage Tutorials (C.3)
- 2019 **People's Choice Award, Google Girls' Hackathon**
 Leading a team of 5 undergraduate students to develop a game app.
- 2017 **2nd Prize of ACM Competition, Peking University**

Service

Program Committee

- 2026 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Poster
- 2025 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Late Breaking Work

Peer Reviewing

- 2026 – 2027 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
- 2024 – 2026 ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)
- 2026 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Poster
- 2025 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC), Poster
- 2025 ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C)
- 2025 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Late Breaking Work
- 2023 – 2024 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
- 2023 – 2024 ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW)
- 2022 – 2023 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Late Breaking Work
- 2022 The Journal of Computer Languages (COLA)
- 2022 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)

2023 ACM CHI student volunteer

Teaching

Winter 2026 Graduate Student Instructor – SI 201 (Data-Oriented Programming)
University of Michigan

Fall 2025 Graduate Student Instructor – SI 201 (Data-Oriented Programming)
University of Michigan

Fall 2024 Graduate Student Instructor – SI 579 (Building Interactive Applications)
University of Michigan

Mentoring

Mentees

2025 **Shamita Rao**
University of Michigan Master student, School of Information

2024 – 2025 **Yinuo Yang**
University of Michigan Undergraduate Student
Next position: PhD student at the University of Notre Dame

2024 **Zhixuan Chen**
University of Michigan Master Student, Computer Science and Engineering
Next position: Software Developer Engineer at Amazon

2021 **Shiyu Xu**
University of Michigan Master Student, School of Information
Next position: PhD student at the University of Michigan